

About The Company

Citibank is the consumer banking division of Citigroup, one of the world's largest financial services organizations. Citibank offers a wide range of financial products and services to individuals, businesses, and institutions, including retail banking, wealth management, global transaction services, etc. Citibank has a significant international presence with operations in numerous countries and serves millions of customers globally.

Citi CSC stands for **Citi Solutions Centers**. It is a global network of technology centers that provide support to Citi's core businesses and clients around the world. The centers are in strategic locations across the globe, including Pune, India, where one of Citi's largest technology centers is located. They deal with Markets & Securities, Risk & Capital Management, Cash Management, Trade & Treasury Services, Private Banking, Mobile, Compliance & Surveillance Technology, Finance and Risk Mitigation.

Citi CSC came to our college to recruit for 2 of their domains:

- **International Consumer Group (ICG):** This domain focused more on development. Knowledge on microservices, Java, Apache server, Kafka and app development were tested in the online round for students who chose this domain, and the coding round for this test included the coding of a form (don't really remember the details).
- **Enterprise Operations & Technology (EO&T):** This was the domain I picked as it aligned a lot more with the fields I am passionate about, i.e. cybersecurity and testing. The job description included tasks like risk analysis and mitigation, data protection, web and mobile app testing, API development and integration, analytics, and a lot more. I have explained the test and the interview process for this domain in detail.

Online Round:

Platform: SHL Amcat

- **Verbal Section:** Consisted of questions on reading comprehension, grammar, vocabulary, and elementary grammar skills [14 questions - 20 mins]
- **Advanced Aptitude:** Questions were based on number sequences, text encoding, blood relations, logic puzzles, etc. [12 questions - 12 minutes]
- **CS Fundamentals:** Algorithms, basic DBMS, code error correction, finding the output, etc. [12 questions - 12 minutes]
- **Coding:** 2 questions (total 45 mins) - no. of negative numbers in an array, sum of prime numbers within a given range [since the questions were extremely easy, they could be completed in less than 5 minutes XD]

Round 1: Tech Round [Two interviewers]

- During the interview, we kicked things off with the standard "Tell us about yourself." However, the conversation took an interesting turn when they discovered I'm not originally from Chennai. One of the interviewers was curious about how I coped with the language barrier, considering that Tamil is the predominant language in Chennai. I explained that after a decade of living in Chennai, I had become decently fluent in Tamil. I also mentioned that I continued to learn and improve my language skills as it wasn't my mother tongue.
- Then, they delved into my resume, where I had listed problem-solving as one of my skills. They asked for a real-life example of how I had applied this skill, so I shared a relevant experience.
- The interview also got technical with questions about file handling and database management systems (DBMS). For most of these questions, I had to walk them through the logic step by step. In one instance, they asked me to write an SQL query on paper.
- Next, we ventured into discussions about data structures. They were curious about which data structures I was familiar with, and this led to conversations about linked lists and their related problems.
- I was asked to explain the different kinds of trees, and I had accidentally mentioned AVL trees, and that sparked a more in-depth discussion. The interviewer delved into how AVL trees function, their significance, and their practical applications.
- They also chose one of my projects and asked me to provide a detailed explanation. They were keen to know my thoughts on potential improvements for the project.
- They inquired about my decision to pick the EO&T domain, wanting to understand my motivations and reasons for choosing this specific field.
- They threw in a more casual question about my familiarity with Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) concepts. I mentioned that I had a basic understanding of OOP.
- As the interview concluded, they gave me the opportunity to ask any questions I had in mind.

Round 2: Managerial Round [Two Interviewers]

- The interview began with the customary request for a self-introduction. Subsequently, they inquired about my place of origin once again, seeking to understand more about my background.
- The conversation then shifted towards a discussion about the backend mechanism of payment apps like GPay. While I didn't have a complete grasp of the topic, I made an effort to provide a reasonable answer. In response, the

interviewer acknowledged my attempt and said I was close, and then patiently explained the intricate workings behind GPay.

- They were also curious about my pursuits outside of academics. Specifically, they wanted to know how I had explored and pursued my passions beyond the classroom.
- The interview delved into teamwork and collaboration when I was asked to narrate a situation in which I encountered difficulty working in a team and how I resolved it. They also inquired about who took the initiative to address the issue. Additionally, I was asked if there had been instances where I had to delegate my responsibilities to a teammate.
- I had mentioned my certification as a piano player in my resume, which piqued their interest. They asked me about my music interests, including my preferred style, favorite composer, and the pieces that resonated with me.
- The discussion turned to my technical interests, which I had highlighted in my resume. They noticed my inclination towards core subjects and asked why I hadn't considered pursuing higher studies.
- Given that I had expressed an interest in research in the "About Me" section of my resume, I was asked to elaborate on why I found research intriguing and what drew me to it.
- They were keen to understand why I would like to work in the finance sector and how it aligned with my career growth.
- Looking to the future, they asked about my two-year career aspirations and my long-term plans beyond that timeframe.
- The interview concluded by offering me the opportunity to ask questions I had

Round 3: HR Round [One Interviewer]

- The interview commenced with the interviewer introducing himself, setting a conversational tone. After that, he invited me to introduce myself and share a bit about my background.
- We then discussed my experiences with Citi so far, as he inquired about how my journey with the company had been up to that point.
- He asked me whether I had any relatives employed in the government or in Citi.
- One of the projects I had prominently featured on my resume involved a website designed to facilitate Food Donation Management. He was keen to know what had motivated me to choose this particular project and delve into its working.
- Noticing that I had listed proficiency in around five languages on my resume, the interviewer inquired about the reasons behind my pursuit of multiple languages, wanting to understand the motivations behind each one.
- As the conversation continued, he asked if there was any recent achievement in my life that I felt particularly proud of.

- I was then asked about what my greatest weakness was, to which I elaborated on and mentioned ways in which I successfully battled it and how I'm still continuing to work on it.
- Finally, the interview came to a close, and he provided me with the opportunity to ask any questions I might have about the company or the role.

All the interviews took place on the same day, in-person at CUIIC.

There were about 20 students shortlisted from 100 who picked the EO&T domain, and by GOD'S GRACE I was one of the 5 students selected for the summer internship.

My Tips:

- DO NOT PANIC. At least with respect to Citi, the interview process is really chilled out and there is absolutely no need to stress
- Don't spend too much time on a single aptitude question. And on certain platforms like Amcat, they do not let you switch between questions or go back to a previous question, so tackle the questions on the spot and wisely.
- The hiring committee really values students who have clear-cut interests and goals; those who know exactly what and why they want to do it.
- At the same time, they are looking for those who have a strong passion to learn and explore everything; no company wants rigid and the always-in-your-comfort-zone kind of employees
- Try at least attempting to answer all the questions thrown at you
- If you are asked something you don't know, try to give a basic logical answer and make sure to mention that it is something you are open to learning/improving and you haven't had the opportunity to explore it just yet
- I received easy coding questions, but that may not be the case with other domains and companies. I had close to no coding practice for the internship drive and that is something I regret. Make sure you start practicing well in advance
- DO NOT lie on your resume. Interviewers will easily be able to figure out whether you have bluffed or not
- Know what the company does, how your skillset will benefit them and how they can help your career advance
- Know your projects inside-out, every little detail can be questioned. Know the shortcomings of your project beforehand so that you're not caught by surprise
- Do not put a rating or level for your technical skills. I had done that and it landed me into slight trouble.

Feel free to reach out!

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All the very best!!!